M_Wave_Lite

Description

Wave Lite is a simple animated material designed to create soft wave-like motion across a texture.

It adds gentle directional movement to stylized VFX surfaces, making the texture feel more alive without using complex animation controls.

This Lite version is designed as a lightweight introduction to animated shader materials and includes only basic wave controls.

For base texture, tint, emission, and tiling settings, see the **M_BaseColor_Lite** documentation.

Use Cases

Recommended for:

- Magic energy surfaces
- Soft animated VFX planes
- Portal surface motion
- Fantasy glow materials
- Liquid-like energy movement
- Decorative stylized surfaces
- UI-like VFX panels
- Preview materials for the full shader packs

Wave Parameters

Wave Speed

Default: `0.3`

Controls how fast the wave motion moves across the surface.

Recommended values:

0 — no movement

0.1 — very slow wave
0.3 — default soft wave motion
0.5 — more visible movement
1.0+ — fast stylized wave

Use lower values for calm magical surfaces or background effects.
Use higher values for more active energy, portals, or stronger animated VFX.

Wave Strength

Default: `0.03`

Controls how strongly the texture is displaced by the wave motion.

Recommended values:

0 — no wave distortion
0.01 — very subtle movement
0.03 — default soft wave
0.05 — more visible wave
0.08+ — strong stylized distortion

For most materials, keep this value subtle.
Too much strength can make the texture look overly distorted or hard to read.

Wave Direction

Controls the direction of the wave movement.

Depending on the engine version, this control may appear as:

Wave Direction (X, Y)

or as separate parameters:

Wave Direction X
Wave Direction Y

Recommended examples:

X = 1, Y = 0 — horizontal wave direction
X = -1, Y = 0 — reverse horizontal direction

X = 0, Y = 1 — vertical wave direction
X = 0, Y = -1 — reverse vertical direction
X = 1, Y = 0.25 — subtle diagonal wave
X = 1, Y = 1 — diagonal wave direction

Diagonal values often create a more natural and less mechanical motion.

Recommended Settings

Soft Magic Wave

Wave Speed: 0.1–0.3
Wave Strength: 0.01–0.03
Wave Direction: 1, 0.25

Best for calm magical surfaces, background energy, and soft decorative VFX.

Portal Surface Wave

Wave Speed: 0.3–0.5
Wave Strength: 0.03–0.05
Wave Direction: 0, 1

Best for portal planes, magical gates, energy walls, and vertical animated surfaces.

Strong Stylized Wave

Wave Speed: 0.5–1.0
Wave Strength: 0.05–0.08
Wave Direction: 1, 1

Best for more active or exaggerated VFX surfaces.

Use stronger settings carefully, especially on highly detailed textures.

Best Practices

- Use seamless textures for best results.

- Keep Wave Strength low for clean and readable motion.
- Use diagonal Wave Direction values for more organic movement.
- Combine Wave Speed with texture tiling to control the perceived motion density.
- Use Bloom in the scene for stronger glowing results.
- For gameplay surfaces, avoid very high Wave Strength values.
- For advanced wave controls, multi-wave motion, vertex animation, distortion, pulse, or radial effects, use the full shader packs.

Limitations

This Lite material is intentionally simplified.

It does not include:

- Advanced wave controls
- Public frequency control
- Multiple wave layers
- Vertex displacement
- Noise-based wave variation
- Pulse controls
- Distortion blending
- Radial or vortex motion
- Opacity / alpha controls
- Custom gradient color mode
- Advanced masking

This material is designed as a lightweight free version for simple animated wave-style VFX.

Summary

Wave Lite provides:

- Simple animated wave movement
- Adjustable wave speed
- Adjustable wave strength
- Adjustable wave direction
- Lightweight stylized VFX behavior
- A beginner-friendly preview of the G-Spot Lab shader workflow

For base texture, tint, emission, and tiling controls, see the **M_BaseColor_Lite** documentation.